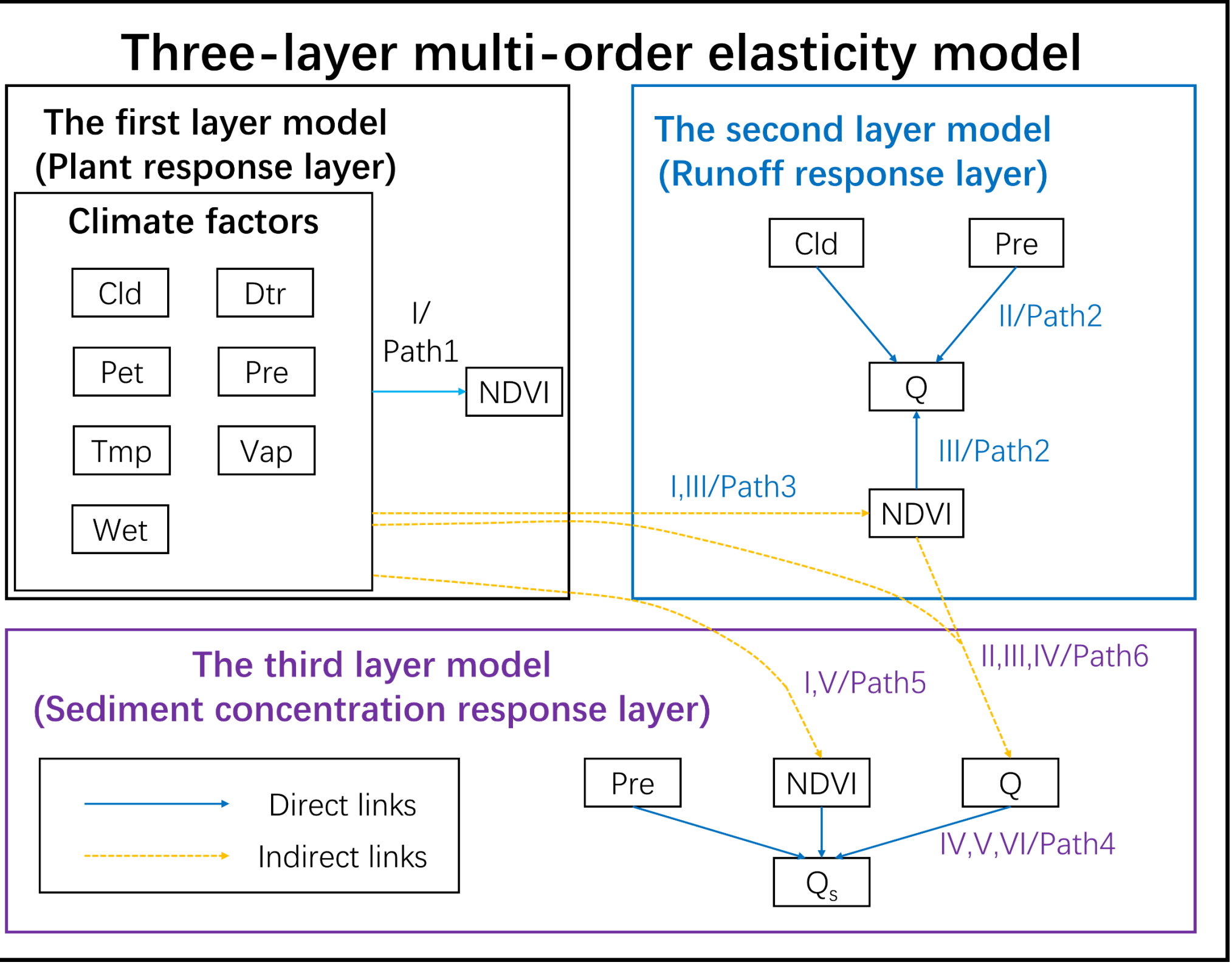

Three-layer multi-order elasticity model
The first layer model
(Plant response layer)
Climate factors
Cld
Dtr
Pet
Pre
Tmp
Vap
Wet
I/
Path1
NDVI
The second layer model
(Runoff response layer)
Cld
Pre
II/Path2
Q
III/Path2
I,III/Path3
NDVI
The third layer model
(Sediment concentration response layer)
I,V/Path5
II,III,IV/Path6
Direct links
Indirect links
Pre
NDVI
Q
IV,V,VI/Path4
Qs